IDEATION PHASE

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

Date	30 October 2026
Team ID	Not provided
Project Name	Software Installation Request – ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorming and Idea Prioritization

This document records the ideas considered for a ServiceNow-based software installation request process. The goal is to give employees a consistent way to request software, route requests for manager approval, coordinate fulfillment with the Software Support Team, and communicate whether installation was completed or delayed because a license was unavailable.

Step 1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Problem Statement

Problem Identification

Problem Area	Identified Issue
Unstructured software requests	Employees need a consistent request channel that captures the software name, version, business reason, and urgency instead of relying on incomplete or informal requests.
Approval and ownership	Requests need manager approval before fulfillment, followed by clear assignment to the team responsible for installing the software.
License availability	A requested product may not have an available license. The process needs a defined way to record the exception and explain the expected delay.
Limited status communication	Requesters need a clear outcome notification when installation is completed or when a new license must be obtained.

Problem Statement

Employees need a centralized and trackable way to request software installation. The process must capture the required software details, obtain the requester's manager approval, create a fulfillment task for the Software Support Team, and keep the requester informed. It must also handle license shortages by recording the appropriate status, notifying the requester of an estimated one-week delay, and supporting incident creation for a license issue.

Step 2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

The following ideas were grouped into the main capabilities needed for the request-to-fulfillment process. They reflect the solution designed in ServiceNow rather than unrelated or unimplemented features.

Idea	Feature / Solution	Group
Idea 1	Create a Service Catalog item with variables for software name, version, business reason, and urgency.	Request Intake
Idea 2	Route the Requested Item to the requester's manager for approval using Flow Designer.	Approval
Idea 3	After approval, create a Catalog Task and assign it to the Software Support Team.	Fulfillment

Step 2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping (continued)

Idea	Feature / Solution	Group
Idea 4	Wait for the Catalog Task to reach a decision state, then branch according to Closed Complete or Pending.	Task Monitoring
Idea 5	Send a personalized completion email or a license-unavailable email, using requester and catalog-variable details.	Notifications
Idea 6	Create an Incident from the Requested Item when its state is On Hold for a license issue.	Exception Handling
Idea 7	Use an Update Set to capture the configuration and test the end-to-end request, approval, task, and notification paths.	Deployment & Testing

Key Objectives

• Standardize software requests and capture the information needed for fulfillment.

• Ensure manager approval is completed before a fulfillment Catalog Task is created.

• Route approved work to the Software Support Team and monitor its task status.

• Notify the requester of successful installation or a license-related delay.

• Create an Incident when the Requested Item is moved to On Hold for a license issue.

Step 3: Idea Prioritization

Ideas were prioritized according to their importance to a working request and fulfillment process, and their feasibility within the ServiceNow configuration used for this project.

Priority	Feature	Reason
High	Catalog item and request variables	The request cannot be processed consistently unless the software, version, business reason, and urgency are captured.
High	Manager approval and Catalog Task creation	Approval controls whether fulfillment proceeds; the task gives the Software Support Team a record of work to complete.
High	Task status monitoring and outcome emails	The process needs to distinguish successful completion from a license shortage and communicate the correct outcome.
Medium	License-issue Incident automation and Update Set packaging	These support exception handling, traceability, and moving the configuration between instances after the core flow is working.

Implementation Map

Implementation Phase	Included Features	Priority
Phase 1 – Request Intake	Software Installation Request catalog item and four request variables.	**High**
Phase 2 – Approval	Flow Designer approval assigned to the requester's manager; approved requests continue to fulfillment.	**High**
Phase 3 – Fulfillment	Create a Catalog Task for the Requested Item, assign it to Software Support Team, and wait for Closed Complete or Pending.	**High**
Phase 4 – Notifications & Exceptions	Send the appropriate personalized email; create an Incident when the Requested Item is On Hold for a license issue; package configuration in the Update Set.	**Medium**

Implementation notes: The solution uses Flow Designer, not Legacy Workflow. The Create Catalog Task action is configured with its Wait option off; a separate Wait For Condition checks the Catalog Task. In this project, **Pending** is used as the license-unavailable signal because the available Catalog Task state choices did not include On Hold. This is a project convention, not a general definition of the Pending state. Separately, the Incident Business Rule is configured on Requested Item [sc_req_item] for the On Hold condition. Catalog variables are retrieved with the Get Catalog Variables action for use in the personalized emails.